



GAGE Sensitive and Tricky Questions



Sensitive Topics

Balancing the need to gather critically important information, while also respecting local cultural and political appropriateness

*Consider the following, as the discussion continues:
What topics and questions should be completely avoided?*

Tips for rewording

Suggestions for proxy measures

Marriage

Survey Questions

- Attitudes towards and experience with marriage and relationships.
- (1) Marital History; (2) Knowledge and Opinions; (3) Attitudes; (4) Getting Married

Rationale

- Among refugee girls living in Jordan, the rate of child marriage may have doubled - to about one in four - since the beginning of the Syrian conflict, as families try to both preserve their own scarce resources and protect their daughters from sexual violence.

Discussion

- At what age is it appropriate to ask about current and past marriage status? (same for girls and boys?)
- Is it appropriate to ask about desirability of marriage?

Health (plus SRH), Nutrition and Disability

Survey Questions

- Major health complications, symptoms and Injuries
- Food security
- SRH information source, desired fertility, attitudes and pregnancy
- Physical health and functioning

Rationale

- Adolescents have unique health care needs, specifically in refugee populations
- Rates of adolescent pregnancy are climbing, with 11% of births in Za'atari camp in 2014 to girls under 18.
- Syrian girls are also far more vulnerable to food insecurity
- Girls with disabilities, are twice as likely to experience neglect and abuse as their non-disabled peers.

Discussion

- What is appropriate to ask about fertility?
- What is appropriate to ask about sexual and reproductive sensitivity? To whom (AF and CR)?

Violence

Survey Question

- Household members' attitude towards and exposure to several different types of violence
- (1)Attitudes towards violence (2)Peer-violence (3)Physical violence at home (4)Provided support

Rationale

- Vulnerable to all types of violence
- Refugee boys are likely to be bullied and humiliated by peers, teachers and employers

Discussion

- What types of violence (GBV, peer, home) should be avoided?
- Specific topics to add?

Refugee Specific Themes

- Refugee Status
- Shocks
- Resilience
- Conflict Experience



Shocks, Resilience and Conflict Experience

Survey Questions

- Household experience with negative events like death of a family member, loss of livestock/employment/food or natural disasters
- Arabic Child and Youth Resilience Measure
- Harvard Trauma Questionnaire

Rationale

- Post-conflict and fragile state situation may face the traumatizing impact of direct exposure to violence as well as stressful living conditions
- Leads to serious mental health and emotional consequences

Discussion

- Are there topics to be avoided (political or cultural sensitivity)?
- Are there recommended, adolescent-friendly scales?
- Important additions?
- Population interview fatigue

Refugee Status

Survey Questions

- Current status of, desirability to and barriers of registration with UNHRC and Jordan's Ministry of Interior.
- Displacement history

Rationale

- Understand household's awareness of and access to social, economic and political services, as a result of registration status

Discussion

- What is else is important to collect about refugee status?

Different Populations/Locations

Challenge of ensuring that the survey is appropriate for the different populations and locations

- Using tablets for data collection allows us to skip sections that are not relevant for certain populations and allows for different response options based on population/location.*
- What are topics that are only relevant for certain populations?*
- What are topics that are only relevant for certain locations?*
- What other challenges should we be aware of in surveying such a diverse population and what are some potential solutions?*

Overview of Training

AF: Household Roster
AF: Family Background
AF: Household Member Details
AF Durable Goods
AF Contact Information
AF and CR: Violence Section
CR: Time Allocation
CR: Health and Nutrition
CR: Sexual and Reproductive Health
Same-sex interviewing tips



AF: Household Roster

- **HH Roster**
- The head of household is the person
 - commonly regarded by the household members as their head.
 - often, but not always, the main income earner and decision maker for the household.
 - The household head may not reside at the home,
 - for example if s/he is working as a migrant elsewhere and sending income back to the household.

A Few Additional Notes on GAGE Households

- **Prompt #1:** Includes all small children and infants
- **Prompt #2:** We will include domestic help (and children of domestic help), lodgers, or friends, who usually live here but may not “eat from the same pot”.
 - The individual must live at the dwelling to count as a lodger. Someone who pays to eat meals with the Household would not count
- **Prompt #3:** We will include other people that are typically members of your household but have lived elsewhere for 3 months or more due to migration for work.
 - For example, if the biological mother of the CR works in another country currently but will be back in the future, she should be added to the roster here

AF: Household Roster

- **Household Member Details**
- Foundation of the survey – important to do this correctly. The purpose is to understand the relationships between hh members.
- Example: Q5 . This question is used to determine the relationship of each household member to the household head. Please see some examples:
 - **The HH member in question is the CR and the HH head is the CR's father:** then the relationship of the CR to the HH head is “Daughter” or “Son.”
 - **The HH member in question is the AF and the HH head is the AF's husband:** then the relationship of the AF to the HH head is “Spouse/Partner”
 - **The HH head is the father of the HH member in question:** then the relationship of the HH member to the HH head is “Son” or “Daughter”
- Similarly, for the other relationship questions in this section (relationship to AF respondent, relationship to CR) – **make sure to read prompt at end of question!** “The ____ is the household head's ____.” This will help answer correctly.

AF: Household Roster

- **Household Head**
- Q18. This is the year the HH head moved to *the present location*, does not matter from where they moved.
- Q19. This question asks if the CR's mother was living in this location when the CR was born. This question is asked this way in order to understand the location of the household at the time that the CR was born.



AF: Family Background

- **CR's Biological Father and Mother Deceased or Alive.**
 - CR's Biological Father
 - CR's Biological Mother
- **Be sure to record a response about the age of the father or mother, not the age of the CR, at the time of the death.**

AF: Household Member Details

- Q9 This question is to determine the highest level of education attended for each household member.

**highest level
attended**

**highest level
completed.**

AF: Durable Goods

- **Quantity of *[Working]* Durable Goods Owned**
 - Durable Goods
- **What we mean by "working"**
- **Consider the following:**
 - The refrigerator, if plugged into electricity would work?
 - The car, if it had gas in it or the battery was charged would work?
- **What is your opinion about the durable goods on the right? Working or Not Working? Why?**



AF Contact Information

- **Contact Info**
- BE SURE TO READ PROMPTS to make sure to get relationship correct (same as in HH Roster section).

AF and CR: Violence

- **Violence**
- **CR Other Modules, Violence**
- **PRIVACY IS CRITICALLY IMPORTANT**
 - Double-check for privacy before beginning
 - Stop questioning as soon as you realize you may not be alone, or someone else can hear
- **Tips on sensitivity**
 - Do not probe extensively, but do encourage engagement
 - Pay attention to body language to monitor discomfort
- **Your opinion: How do you appropriately ask another person to leave during this section?**
Brainstorm ways of obtaining privacy



CR: Time Allocation

- **Time Allocation (Young Cohort)**
 - Work with the CR to allocate their beans; this will keep the survey moving faster. Walk through the categories with them using the paper.
- **Time Allocation (Old Cohort)**
 - Do not read the categories. Ask them to tell you what activities they did during that day (and when they did them), and you categorize what they tell you.

Time Allocation : Learning the categories

- Travelling to and from private tuition/ tutoring
- CR goes to lesson/girl club to learn sewing
- School work or private tuition
- Play sports

CR: Sexual and Reproductive Health

- **Some questions can be uncomfortable for CR**
 - Fertility
 - Puberty
- **Tips on sensitivity**
 - Do not probe extensively, but do encourage engagement
 - Pay attention to body language to monitor discomfort
- **PRIVACY IS CRITICALLY IMPORTANT**



Miscellaneous From Training and Pilot

- **CR Paid Work:** If the CR is paid once a month, please convert monthly salary to be weekly to enter for “How much paid in past 7 days”
- **HH Roster, Member details:** Round down to the nearest year for age. If someone is 15 years and 7 months, that person is 15
- **Dwelling Characteristics:** If building of home is owned, then the home is owned, even if the government owns the land
- **CR Education:** The Exam period does not count as school being in session
- **CR Health:** Persistent headaches/ cough – these are regular/frequent coughing episodes or headaches that occur over the past two weeks

Privacy

- **As researchers it is our responsibility to ensure privacy of the respondent**
- **One primary way to cause harm to a study participant is to share any information that is learned.**
 - Accidentally share health status
 - Accidentally sharing information about sexual activity
- **No person other than the interviewer and respondent should be present at the interview**
 - If ANYONE enters the interview space while it is in session, stop the interview and politely ask those individuals to leave
 - Speak softly
- **As an interviewer, it is your responsibility to maintain confidentiality of any information that you learn**

General Rules

- **Address questions only to the respondent**
- **Read the questions as written.**
 - Read aloud all black text.
 - Do not read *italicized* text.
- **Ask the questions in the order they are given**
 - Maintain Skip patterns
- **Ask the question even if you think you know the answer**

Same-sex Interviewing

- We will try to match the sex of the enumerator with the sex of the respondent, but sometimes that is not possible. When same-sex interviewing is not possible, we still want to:
 - Minimize extreme discomfort for enumerators and respondents.
 - Respect appropriate cultural norms.
 - Are there any cultural norms that make same-sex interviewing uncomfortable?
 - Do you have any tips to address these norms?
 - Maintain the quality of the data received.
 - Data quality can be compromised when enumerators or respondents feel uncomfortable.

Tips for interviewing a respondent of the opposite sex

Role Play

- Which questions might be especially difficult to ask a respondent of the opposite sex?
- Did anyone ask that question to a respondent of the opposite sex, during the field testing, and feel very comfortable asking it?
- What tips do you have for asking that specific question?
- Can you demonstrate your interviewing techniques?

Contact us



EMAIL:
gage@odi.org.uk



WEBSITE:
www.gage.odi.org



TWITTER:
[@GAGE_programme](https://twitter.com/GAGE_programme)